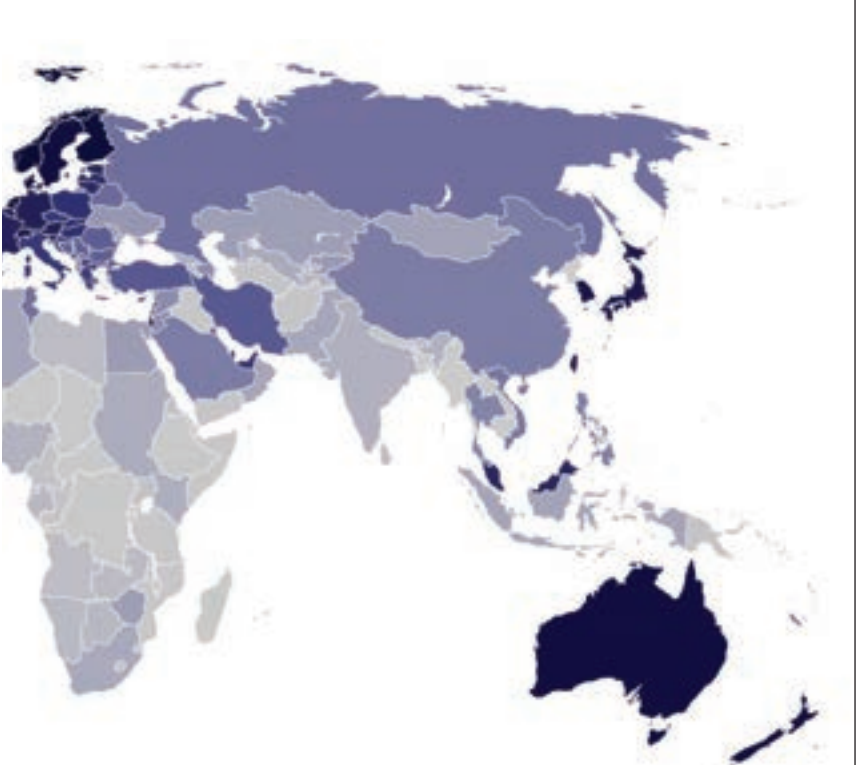


1.1 Why web services?

Although we'd all love to believe all those news stories all those years ago that heralded the coming of the internet age in India, it was all just a lot of hype. Sure we have a few million people online... OK, fine! India has a whopping 81 million people who have used the internet, at some point in their lives, give or take a few million, but considering that just a decade ago this figure was about 5.5 million, and that even as little as five years ago, this was a mere 27 million, you get the big picture.

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Internet penetration across the globe. Source Wikimedia and internetworldstats.com